# 3. Deadline undercutting

Read every advertised deadline, then declare one step earlier than all of them.

### Advertised at K

| Peer | Deadline |
|---|---|
| **H1** | now + 11.4 s |
| **H2** | now + 12.8 s |
| **H3** | now + 13.8 s |
| **A** | just under 11.4 s |

undercut the earliest →

**Leader election**

earliest deadline wins

A leads; A admits whom it likes

Cost to A: one identity,
no compute, no crafted node ID